and that their "apologists" are comparable to the Gestapo; and Michael Neumann's equation of "Jewish complicity" in Israel's policies with German complicity in the Holocaust illustrate the extremity of such language and the views it projects. Citing innumerable examples of such tendentious thinking, I closed my 2006 essay by noting that "at a time when the delegitimization and, ultimately, the eradication of Israel is a goal being voiced with mounting fervor by the enemies of the Jewish state, it is more than disheartening to see Jews themselves adding to the vilification."

Many readers agreed with these conclusions, but some, like Alan Wolfe, a political scientist at Boston College, seemed to be in "a state of shock." Confronting me on NPR's "On Point" discussion program, Wolfe accused the article of employing "Stalinist tactics" to stifle free speech and suppress open debate. Michael Lerner, editor of *Tikkun*, told the *International Herald Tribune*'s Roger Cohen, "The atmosphere is hysterical, verging on McCarthyism. You can't raise questions about Israel without being told you're an antisemite or a self-hating and disloyal Jew." The *Boston Globe* ran a story by Stanley Kutler under the absurd heading, "All critics of Israel aren't antisemites," which carries the fantastic charge that my "real targets" are "Democrats and opponents of George W. Bush's dubious adventure into Iraq." Writing in the *New York Review of Books*, George Soros denounced my essay as an instrument of a "pro-Israel lobby" and an "insidious" means of stifling debate**.** And the Jewish newspaper the *Forward* lost its editorial wits altogether in featuring a piece headed "Infamy,**"** claiming that my intent was to "turn Jews against liberalism and silence critics" and, for these alleged sins, placing me in their secular version of *cherem*.

Since I never once referred to "liberalism," called no one a "Jewish antisemite" or "self-hating Jew," said nothing about Democrats or the Iraq war, and made no attempt to "silence" anyone, this Kakfaesque bill of indictment made me wonder what was at play here—illiteracy, dishonesty, or worse? As Bret Stephens put it, "How does *joining* a debate become an effort to suppress it?"

Vigorous discussion of Israeli policies and actions is not in dispute here. Such discussion proceeds across all of the media of communication in the United States and even more so within Israel itself. It is disingenuous, therefore, to say that "you can't raise questions about Israel." Such questions are raised continually by a broad range of commentators, including Yossi Klein Halevi, Michael Oren, Dennis Ross, Ari Shavit, Hillel Halkin, David Makovsky, and Michael Walzer, to name only a few.

The ubiquitous rubric "criticism of Israel," however, designates another kind of discourse. Those who think and write within the terms of this genre

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